

Does Alcohol Consumption Affect Depression

Among High School Students?

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Research Question

Does current alcohol use relate to feeling sad or hopeless for two or more weeks?

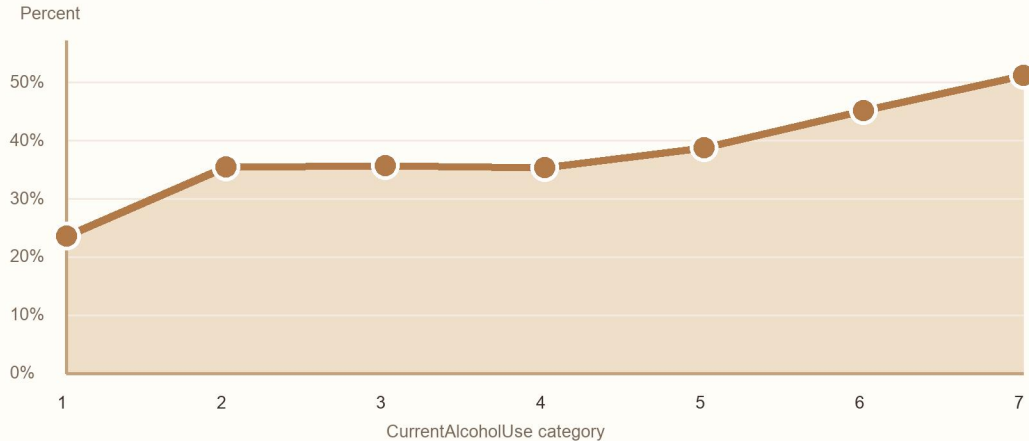
Variables

X: CurrentAlcoholUse
Y: Depression indicator
(1 = SadOrHopeless yes)

Method

Data cleaning, descriptive figures, and simple OLS regression.

Depression Rate by Alcohol Use Category



Key Results

- 12,610 students after removing missing values
- 29.4% reported feeling sad or hopeless
- +0.044 higher depression probability per alcohol-use category
- 0.016 R-squared: small explanatory power

Interpretation

Students with higher alcohol-use categories showed a higher probability of reporting sadness or hopelessness. The relationship is statistically significant, but the low R-squared means alcohol use is only one part of adolescent mental health.

Conclusion

Current alcohol use is associated with depressive symptoms among high school students. Schools should pay attention to both alcohol prevention and mental health support.

Clean Data
drop missing values

Recode Outcome
1 = depression reported

Analyze
OLS regression

Communicate
figures + summary

Note: SadOrHopeless was recoded so 1 = reported feeling sad or hopeless. Results are observational and do not prove causation.